THE BOOK OF

NAHUM

Goodness and Severity of Jehovah. The Overthrow of Nineveh decreed

1 The [1] [a]burden of [b]Nineveh. The book of the vision of Nahum the Elkoshite.

2 [c]Jehovah is a jealous God and avengeth; Jehovah [d]avengeth and is full of wrath; Jehovah taketh [e]vengeance on his adversaries, and he reserveth *wrath* for his enemies. 3 Jehovah is [f]slow to anger, and great in power, and will by no means clear *the guilty*: Jehovah hath his way in the [g]whirlwind and in the storm, and the [h]clouds are the dust of his feet. 4 He [i]rebuketh the sea, and maketh it dry, and drieth up all the rivers: [k]Bashan languisheth, and Carmel; and the flower of Lebanon languisheth. 5 The mountains [l]quake at him, and the hills [m]melt; and the earth is [n]upheaved at his presence, yea, the [o]world, and all that dwell therein. 6 Who can stand before his [p]indignation? and who can abide in the [q]fierceness of his anger? his [r]wrath is poured out like fire, and the [s]rocks are broken asunder by him. 7 Jehovah is [t]good, a [u]stronghold in the day of trouble; and he knoweth them that take refuge in him. 8 But with an [v]over-running flood he will make a full end of her place, and will pursue his enemies into [x]darkness.

9 What do ye [y]devise against Jehovah? he will make a [z]full end; affliction shall not rise up the second time. 10 For entangled like [a]thorns, and [b]drunken as with their drink, they are [c]consumed [2]utterly as dry stubble. 11 There is one gone forth out of thee, that [d]deviseth evil against Jehovah, [3]that [e]counselleth [4]wickedness. 12 Thus saith Jehovah: Though they be in full strength, and likewise many, even so shall they be [f]cut down, and he shall pass away. [5]Though I have afflicted thee, I will afflict thee [g]no more. 13 And now will I [h]break his yoke from off thee, and will burst thy bonds in sunder.

14 And Jehovah hath given commandment concerning thee, that [i]no more of thy name be sown: out of the house of thy gods will I cut off the [k]graven image and the molten image; I will make thy [l]grave; for thou art vile.

*15 Behold, [m]upon the mountains the feet of him that bringeth good tidings, that publisheth peace! [n]Keep thy feasts, O Judah, perform thy vows; for [6]the [o]wicked one shall [p]no more pass through thee; he is [q]utterly cut off.

2 He that [r]dasheth in pieces is come up against thee: [s]keep the fortress, watch the way, make thy loins strong, fortify thy power mightily. 2 For Jehovah restoreth the [t]excellency of Jacob, [u]as the excellency of Israel; for the emptiers have [v]emptied them out, and [z]destroyed their vine-branches. 3 The shield of his mighty men is made red, the valiant men are in [y]scarlet: the chariots [7]flash with steel in the day of his preparation, and the [8]cypress [z]*spears* are brandished. 4 The [a]chariots rage in the streets; they rush to and fro in the broad ways: the appearance of them is like torches; they [b]run like the lightnings. 5 He remembereth his [c]nobles: they [d]stumble in their march; they make haste to the wall thereof, and the mantelet is prepared. 6 The [e]gates of the rivers are opened, and the palace is dissolved. 7 [9]And it is decreed: she is uncovered, she is carried away; and her handmaids [10]*f*moan as with the voice of doves [g]beating upon their [11]breasts.

8 But [h]Nineveh hath been [12]from of old like a [i]pool of water: yet

[a] Is. 13. 1; 19. 1; Jer. 23. 33, 34; Hab. 1. 1; Zech. 9. 1; Mal. 1. 1
[b] ch. 2. 8; 3. 7; 2 K. 19. 36; Jon. 1. 2; Zeph. 2. 13
[c] Ex. 20. 5
[d] Dt. 32. 35, 41
*[Ch. 2. 1 in Heb.]
[e] Ps. 94. 1
[f] Ex. 34. 6, 7
[g] Is. 29. 6; Am. 1. 14
[h] Ps. 104. 3; Is. 19. 1
[i] Ps. 106. 9; Is. 50. 2
[k] Is. 33. 9
[l] Ex. 19. 18
[m] Mic. 1. 4
[n] Is. 24. 1, 20
[o] Ps. 98. 7
[p] Jer. 10. 10
[q] Is. 13. 13
[r] Is. 66. 15
[s] 1 K. 19. 11
[t] Ps. 25. 8; 37. 39, 40
[u] Ps. 28. 8
[v] Is. 28. 2, 18
[x] Is. 13. 9, 10
[y] ver. 11
[z] Is. 28. 22
[a] Mic. 7. 4
[b] Is. 56. 12
[c] Is. 5. 24; 10. 17
[d] ver. 9; Is. 10. 7-11
[e] Ezek. 11. 2
[f] Is. 10. 16-19, 33, 34
[g] Is. 54. 7, 8; Lam. 3. 31-33
[h] Is. 9. 4; 10. 27; Jer. 2. 20
[i] Job 18. 17; Ps. 109. 13; Is. 14. 21, 22; Jer. 22. 30
[k] Is. 46. 1, 2; Mic. 5. 13, 14
[l] Ezek. 32. 22, 23
[m] Is. 40. 9; 52. 7; Rom. 10. 15
[n] Lev. 23. 2, 4
[o] ver. 11
[p] Is. 52. 1; Joel 3. 17
[q] Is. 29. 7, 8
[r] Jer. 51. 20-23
[s] ver. 5; ch. 3. 12, 14
[t] Is. 60. 15
[u] Ezek. 37. 21-23
[v] Jer. 48. 11
[x] Ps. 80. 12, 13
[y] Ezek. 23. 14, 15
[z] Job 39. 23
[a] ch. 3. 2, 3; Is. 66. 15; Ezek. 26. 10
[b] Jer. 4. 13
[c] ch. 3. 18
[d] Jer. 46. 12
[e] ch. 1. 8; 3. 13; Is. 45. 1
[f] Is. 38. 14; 59. 11
[g] Is. 32. 12
[h] ch. 1. 1; 3. 7
[i] Is. 14. 23

[1] Or, *oracle concerning*
[2] Or, *as stubble fully dry*
[3] Or, *a wicked counsellor*
[4] Or, *worthlessness* Heb. *Belial.*
[5] Or, *So will I afflict thee, that I shall afflict &c.*
[6] Or, the man of *worthlessness* Heb. *Belial.*
[7] Heb. *are with fire of steel.*
[8] Heb. *cypress-trees.*
[9] Or, *Huzzab is uncovered &c.*
[10] Or, *lead* her
[11] Heb. *hearts.*
[12] Or, *from the days* that *she* hath been

they flee away. Stand, stand, *they cry*; but [a] none [1] looketh back.
9 [b] Take ye the spoil of silver, take the spoil of gold; for there is no end of the store, the [2] glory of all goodly furniture.
10 She is [c] empty, and void, and waste; and the [d] heart melteth, and the knees smite together, and anguish is in all loins, and the [e] faces of them all are waxed pale.
11 Where is the [f] den of the lions, and the feeding-place of the young lions, where the lion *and* the lioness walked, the lion's whelp, and none made them afraid?
12 The lion did tear in pieces enough for his whelps, and strangled for his lionesses, and [g] filled his caves with prey, and his dens with ravin.
13 Behold, [h] I am against thee, saith Jehovah of hosts, and I will [i] burn her chariots in the smoke, and the sword shall devour thy young lions; and I will [k] cut off thy prey from the earth, and the [l] voice of thy messengers shall no more be heard.

3 [m] Woe to the bloody city! it is all full of lies and rapine; the prey departeth not.
2 The [n] noise of the whip, and the noise of the rattling of wheels, and prancing horses, and bounding chariots,
3 the horseman [3] mounting, and the flashing sword, and the [o] glittering spear, and a [p] multitude of slain, and a great heap of corpses, and there is [q] no end of the bodies; they stumble upon their bodies;—
4 because of the [r] multitude of the whoredoms of the well-favored harlot, the [s] mistress of witchcrafts, that selleth [t] nations through her whoredoms, and families through her witchcrafts.
5 Behold, [u] I am against thee, saith Jehovah of hosts, and I will [v] uncover thy skirts [4] upon thy face; and I will [x] show the nations thy nakedness, and the kingdoms thy shame.
6 And I will [y] cast abominable filth upon thee, and [z] make thee vile, and will set thee as a [a] gazing-stock.
7 And it shall come to pass, that all they that look upon thee shall [b] flee from thee, and say, [c] Nineveh is laid waste: [d] who will bemoan her? whence shall I seek comforters for thee?
8 Art thou better than [e] No-amon,

[a] Jer. 46. 5; 47. 3
[b] Zeph. 1. 18; Rev. 18. 12, 16
[c] ver. 2; Is. 24. 1; 34. 10–15
[d] Ps. 22. 14; Is. 13. 7, 8; Ezek. 21. 7
[e] Joel 2. 6
[f] ch. 3. 1; Is. 5. 29; Jer. 4. 7
[g] Is. 10. 6–14; Jer. 51. 34
[h] ch. 3. 5; Jer. 21. 13; Ezek. 5. 8
[i] Josh. 11. 6, 9; Ps. 46. 9
[k] ch. 3. 1, 12; Is. 49. 24, 25
[l] 2 K. 18. 17–25; 19. 9–13
[m] Ezek. 24. 6, 9
[n] ch. 2. 3, 4; Job 39. 22–25; Jer. 47. 3
[o] Hab. 3. 11
[p] Is. 34. 3; 66. 16
[q] Is. 37. 36; Ezek. 39. 4
[r] Is. 23. 17; Ezek. 16. 25–29; Rev. 17. 1, 2
[s] Is. 47. 9, 12, 13
[t] Rev. 18. 3
[u] ch. 2. 13; Jer. 50. 31; Ezek. 26. 3
[v] Jer. 13. 26
[x] Ezek. 16. 37
[y] Job 9. 31
[z] Job 30. 8; Mal. 2. 9
[a] Is. 14. 16; Jer. 51. 37
[b] ch. 2. 8; Jer. 51. 9
[c] ch. 1. 1; 2. 8; Zeph. 2. 13
[d] Is. 51. 19; Jer. 15. 5
[e] Jer. 46. 25; Ezek. 30. 14–16

[f] Is. 19. 6–8
[g] Is. 20. 5
[h] Gen. 10. 6; Jer. 46. 9; Ezek. 27. 10; 30. 5; 38. 5
[i] 2 Chr. 12. 3; 16. 8
[k] Is. 19. 4; 20. 4
[l] Hos. 13. 16
[m] Joel 3. 3; Obad. 11
[n] Is. 49. 26; Jer. 25. 27
[o] ch. 1. 8; Is. 2. 10, 19; Hos. 10. 8
[p] Is. 28. 4; Hab. 1. 10
[q] Is. 19. 16; Jer. 51. 30
[r] ch. 2. 6; Is. 45. 1, 2

that was situate among the [5] rivers, that had the [f] waters round about her; whose rampart was [6] the sea, *and* her wall was of the sea?
9 [g] Ethiopia and Egypt were her strength, and it was infinite; [h] Put and [i] Lubim were thy helpers.
10 Yet was she [k] carried away, she went into captivity; her [l] young children also were dashed in pieces at the head of all the streets; and they [m] cast lots for her honorable men, and all her great men were bound in chains.
11 Thou also shalt be [n] drunken; thou shalt be [o] hid; thou also shalt seek [7] a stronghold because of the enemy.
12 All thy fortresses shall be *like* fig-trees with the [p] first-ripe figs: if they be shaken, they fall into the mouth of the eater.
13 Behold, thy people in the midst of thee are [q] women; the gates of thy land are set wide [r] open unto thine enemies: the fire hath devoured thy bars.
14 [s] Draw thee water for the siege; [t] strengthen thy fortresses; go into the clay, and tread the mortar; [8] make strong the brickkiln.
15 There shall the [u] fire devour thee; the sword shall cut thee off; it shall devour thee like the canker-worm: make thyself many as the [v] canker-worm; make thyself many as the locust.
16 Thou hast multiplied thy [x] merchants above the stars of heaven: the canker-worm [9] ravageth, and fleeth away.
17 Thy [z] princes are as the locusts, and thy [10] [y] marshals as the swarms of grasshoppers, which encamp in the [11] hedges in the cold day, but when the sun ariseth they flee away, and their place is not known where they are.
18 Thy shepherds [z] slumber, O king of Assyria; thy [a] nobles are at rest; thy people are [b] scattered upon the mountains, and there is none to gather them.
19 There is [c] no assuaging of thy hurt; thy [d] wound is grievous: all that hear the report of thee [e] clap their hands over thee; for upon whom hath not thy [f] wickedness passed continually?

[s] 2 Chr. 32. 3, 4, 11
[t] ch. 2. 1
[u] ver. 13; ch. 2. 13; Is. 66. 15, 16
[v] Joel 1. 4
[x] Is. 23. 8
[y] Jer. 51. 27
[z] Ps. 76. 5, 6; Is. 56. 10; Jer. 51. 57
[a] ch. 2. 5
[b] 1 K. 22. 17; Is. 13. 14
[c] Jer. 46. 11; Mic. 1. 9
[d] Jer. 30. 12
[e] Job 27. 23; Lam. 2. 15
[f] ver. 4; Is. 37. 18

1 Or, *causeth them to turn*
2 Or, *wealth*
3 Or, *charging*
4 Or, *before*
5 Or, *canals* See Ex. 7. 19.
6 That is, the Nile.
7 Or, *a defence against*
8 Or, *lay hold of the brick-mould*
9 Or, *spreadeth himself*
10 Or, *scribes*
11 Or, *walls*